

YEH JUN LEE

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EDUCATION

Ph.D., Marketing — Pamplin College of Business, Virginia Tech Aug 2021 – 2026

Dissertation defended August 2026. Dissertation: “*The Sensory Connotation of Meaning and the Cues That Fit a Brand*”

Advisor: Prof. Frank May

M.S., Marketing — Korea University Business School Mar 2018 – Mar 2020

GPA 4.50 / 4.50 · Academic Excellence Award (highest academic performance in class)

Thesis: “*Safety Paradox of Self-Driving Cars*” (Advisor: Prof. Jongwon Park)

B.B.A. — Korea University Business School Mar 2009 – Feb 2016

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Measurement and computational instrumentation for consumer research; large language models as validated measurement instruments; sensory marketing and cross-modal correspondence; brand meaning; consumer responses to AI; spatial cognition and consumer judgment.

Methods: experimental design and preregistration; psychometric validation and instrument development; LLM-based measurement; text embeddings and computational text analysis; computer vision features; mixed-effects modeling; field and market-level studies.

PUBLICATION

Lee, Y. J., & Park, J. (2022). The safety paradox of self-driving cars. *Asia Marketing Journal*, 23(4), 1.

JOB MARKET PAPER

“From Brand Meaning to Sensory Design: A Shared Map for Choosing Brand Cues”

Sole-authored working paper · targeted to the Journal of Marketing

Brand meanings are abstract, but the sensory cues that express them — a color, a shape, a typeface, a scent — are usually chosen intuitively and evaluated only after launch. This paper proposes sensory connotation as a shared representation that places meanings and candidate cues on common coordinates, making meaning–cue fit measurable before execution. The instrument is validated against criteria the model cannot supply: label-blind image-matching tests, direct convergence with human ratings ($r = .80$), and trained-panel odor ratings. An eight-study program with preregistered studies and replications spans market-level analysis of 6,236 commercial fragrances, fit experiments, a preregistered allocation study ($N = 289$), and a delivered-fragrance choice study.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

“SimSang: Mapping the Geometry of Thought,” *Association for Consumer Research*, Chicago, September 2026.

“SimSang: Mapping the Geometry of Thought,” *Society for Consumer Psychology*, San Diego, March 2026.

“The Geometry of Thought,” *Association for Consumer Research*, Washington, D.C., October 2025 (Art Festival; interactive system demonstration).

“Spatial Sensitivity: Unveiling Its Effects on Consumer Choice and Perception,” *Marketing Science (ISMS)*, Sydney, June 2024.

“Exploring the Impact of AI on Creative Processes: The Role of Baseline Creativity and Intrinsic Motivation,” *Marketing Science (ISMS)*, Miami, June 2023.

“Safety Paradox of Self-Driving Vehicles,” *American Marketing Association Summer Conference*, August 2020.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Meaning-based shopping search. Sensory vectors for fast, low-cost natural-language product search.

Spatial sensitivity. Bounding a scene makes the same movement feel farther (five studies).

Promotions and usage breadth. Discounts lift demand more for multi-use products (3,600 Amazon listings).

Decision models in marketing. Cheap AI judgment models for real-time page adaptation (proposal).

AI and creative processes. Low motivation raises AI reliance, which helps only less creative people.

RESEARCH PLATFORMS

SimSang Brand Fit Index 2026 – present

Cross-modal fit engine placing meanings and candidate cues on one seven-axis sensory representation. Four cue libraries: fragrance; packaging (1,200 items, pixel-derived computer vision over Amazon Berkeley Objects); wine (194); typeface (659). Bilingual English/Korean. simsang-1efb9.web.app

SimSang Typeface Finder 2026 – present

1,569 typefaces ranked against 356 meanings on a shape × weight × feel representation. simsang-type.web.app

SimSang — perceptual dictionary and scent translator 2025 – present

Public deployment of the dissertation instrument, mapping abstract concepts to sensory profiles and fragrance space. simsang-202503.onrender.com

IVDV Explorer 2024 – present

Literature platform organizing marketing and psychology papers by construct (IVs, DVs, moderators, mediators). ivdv-cddf3.web.app

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, Virginia Tech

- Consumer Behavior (undergraduate) — Spring 2026
- Marketing Research (undergraduate) — Spring 2026
- International Marketing (undergraduate) — Spring 2023

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Korea University

Feb 2019 – Mar 2020

HONORS AND AWARDS

Best Track Award in Consumer Behavior, AMA Summer Conference 2020

ACR Sheth Foundation Scholarship, Association for Consumer Research 2026

Academic Excellence Award, Korea University Business School 2019

Research Assistant Scholarship, Korea University Business School 2019 – 2020

Academic Excellence Scholarship, Korea University Business School 2018

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Franklin Templeton Investments — Marketing Associate

Nov 2015 – Dec 2016

Launched two flagship retail funds; developed promotional events and materials; contributed to the Korea-market brand evolution project.

SKILLS

Methods & analysis: R (mixed models), Python (pandas, statsmodels, scikit-learn), experimental design, text embeddings, computer vision features.

Engineering: JavaScript/HTML/CSS, Firebase, SurveyJS, Git; LLM APIs (Anthropic, Google, OpenAI).

Research operations: Qualtrics, CloudResearch, Prolific, SONA.

Languages: Korean (native), English (fluent).